2012 Honda Fit

$5,570 · 165,239 miles · Dealer · Bakersfield, CA

Seller: Car Bakers (dealer), Bakersfield

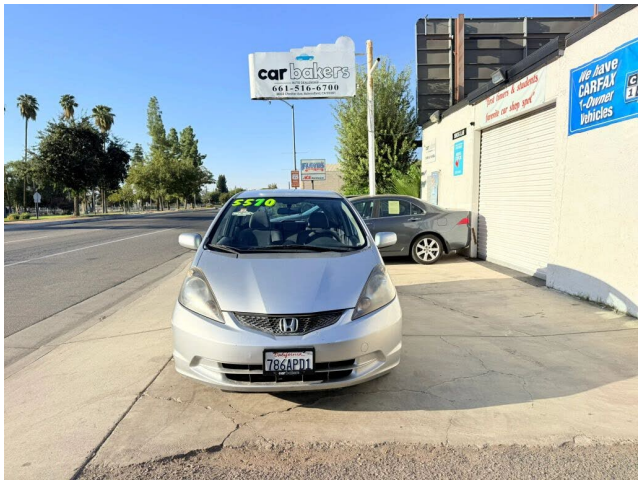
Source: CarGurus

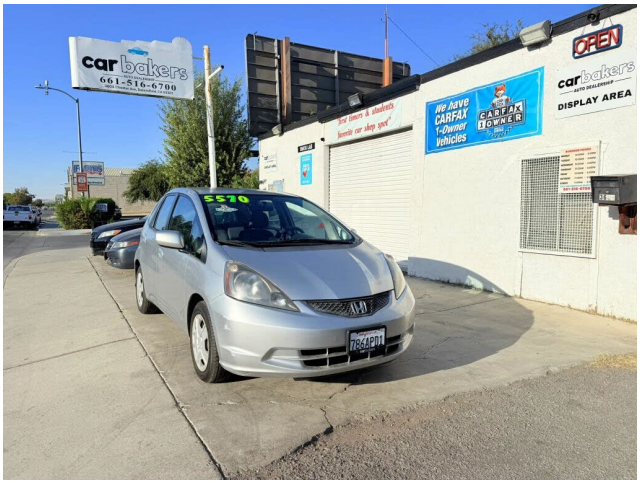
Listing: https://www.cargurus.com/details/455617380

Report generated October 29, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









+ 4 more photos in the app.

Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$6,434	**$447**	**Good**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	4/5 · 11 recalls · 113 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$5,570.00
Sales tax (9.25%)	$515.23
Dealer doc + filing fees	$125.00
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$36.20
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$65.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$6,434.43
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$5,000.00
Amount financed	$1,434.43
Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR)	$28.74
Total interest over the loan	$290.15
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$5,150.00

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$28.74
Insurance (estimate, full)	$135.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 31 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$153.23
Maintenance & repair reserve	$115.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$15.52
Total per month	$447.49

Running costs without the loan: **$419/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$11,709** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Good (4/5)

Good. The 2009-2013 Fit with the 1.5L and a conventional 5-speed automatic (not a CVT) is one of the most dependable small cars of its era - same family as your 2018 Fit pick, for about half the price.

NHTSA data for this model year: 11 recalls · 113 owner complaints (6 involving a crash). Most complaints: Air Bags (41), Steering (16), Power Train (14), Engine (12), Electrical System (9), Vehicle Speed Control (8).

Known issues for this model

• Ignition coil and A/C compressor failures at high miles

• Engine mounts wear

• Rear drum brakes / suspension wear at 165k

Check on this car before buying

• Ask what the reported accident was

• A/C cold after 15 min

• Service records (timing chain engine, but oil changes matter)

• Run VIN for recalls (driver's window switch, airbag)

Notes

$5,570 incl. fees, 165,239 mi. CarGurus 'Great Deal'. Clean title, 1 previous owner, 1 accident reported (no damage reported). 75 days on CarGurus -> room to negotiate.

~2 hr drive from Ridgecrest (CA-178). Confirm availability and get an out-the-door price by phone/text before driving.

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.